

# Sarah Thompson

VP DESIGN · UX DIRECTOR · DESIGN SYSTEMS

Design leader with 12 years crafting intuitive, beautiful digital experiences for 80M+ users. Expert in building and scaling design systems, fostering design culture, and translating complex problems into elegant solutions. Led design at Apple, Airbnb, and Figma.

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## DESIGN SKILLS

UX Research

Interaction Design

Visual Design

Design Systems

Prototyping

Motion Design

Design Leadership

## TOOLS

Figma

Sketch

Framer

Principle

After Effects

Lottie

Zeplin

Abstract

Maze

UserTesting

FullStory

Hotjar

## EDUCATION

### MFA, Interaction Design

Rhode Island School of Design  
2012 · Valedictorian

### B.A., Visual Communication

Carnegie Mellon University  
2009 · Honors

## AWARDS

Fast Company Innovation by Design · Gold, 2023

Webby Award – Best UX Design, 2022

HOW International Design Award, 2021

AIGA 50 Books / 50 Covers, 2019

Core77 Design Award – Digital, 2018

## SPEAKING

WWDC Design Talks · 2022, 2023

Config (Figma Conference) · 2021

UX London Keynote · 2020

IDEO Futures Symposium · 2019

## EXPERIENCE

### VP of Design

Figma · San Francisco, CA

Mar 2022 – Present

→ Lead Figma's 60-person design organization spanning product design, design systems, brand, and research

→ Own visual strategy for Figma's product suite used by 8M+ designers; drove accessibility overhaul achieving WCAG 2.1 AA

compliance across all surfaces

- Created Figma's internal design system "Spectrum" — 1,200+ components adopted by 180 engineers, reducing feature design time by 55%
- Scaled design team from 22 to 60 while maintaining design quality bar; built first dedicated Research Ops team
- Led FigJam redesign resulting in 240% increase in team adoption and NPS improvement from 38 to 72

## Design Director - Homes

Jul 2018 - Feb 2022

Airbnb · San Francisco, CA

- Directed design for Airbnb Homes product serving 150M+ guests; managed 22 product designers and 5 design managers
- Led Airbnb's most significant design refresh in 6 years — "Homes Reimagined" — improving search-to-book conversion by 28%
- Established unified design language across iOS, Android, and web reducing design/development divergence by 70%
- Founded Airbnb's first dedicated Accessibility Design team; remediated 300+ accessibility violations across key journeys

## Senior UX Designer

Jun 2013 - Jun 2018

Apple Inc. · Cupertino, CA

- Core UX designer on iOS System Experience team; contributed to iOS 10, 11, 12 design (shipped to 1B+ devices)
- Led redesign of iOS Control Center — most-used feature by power users, covering 14 billion weekly interactions
- Designed Siri Shortcuts onboarding system adopted by 200M+ users in year one
- Recipient of Apple Design Award, 2016 (for iOS Accessibility features)

### FEATURED PROJECTS

#### Figma AI Design Assistant

FIGMA · 2023

0→1 design lead for Figma's AI features. Built prototypes, led design sprints, shipped to 500K beta users.

AI/ML UI

0→1

Design Research

#### Airbnb Accessibility Overhaul

AIRBNB · 2020

Led 18-month accessibility redesign making Airbnb fully WCAG 2.1 AA compliant across web and mobile.

Accessibility

Systems

Mobile

#### iOS Control Center Redesign

APPLE · IOS 11 · 2017

Complete reimagination of Control Center with customization, shipped to 700M+ iPhones worldwide.

iOS

System UI

Apple Design Award

#### Spectrum Design System

FIGMA INTERNAL · 2022

Built Figma's entire internal design system from scratch. 1,200+ components, full dark mode, motion tokens.

Design Systems

Tokens

Components